Texas Transfers

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Texas Transfers are used to show hands with very long major suits worth a game contract (but not slam) after partner opens or overcalls a natural 1NT. The theory behind Texas Transfers is much the same as that behind Jacoby Transfers: when one hand is stronger than the other, it is best for the strong hand to declare the contract for the purpose of high card concealment. Playing Texas, the following conventional responses to 1NT apply:

Response to 1NT	Meaning
4♦	At least 6 hearts and game values, requiring partner to rebid 4♥.
4♥	At least 6 spades and game values, requiring partner to rebid 4♠.

Texas Transfers can also be used after a natural 2NT opening. The same rules apply except responder can obviously have a weaker hand when committing to game.

Note that 4♦ and 4♥ promise game values, but deny slam values. With a hand interested in slam, responder should start with a Jacoby Transfer and make a forcing rebid at his next turn.

Examples

West	East
♠AQT7	♠5
♥96	♥AJT8742
♦A764	♦K5
♣KQJ	♣T86

West	North	East	South
1NT	Pass	4♦!	Pass
4♥	All Pass		

Holding a 7-card heart suit and sufficient values for game, East bids 4♦. West dutifully bids 4♥.

West	East
♠A2	♠KQ9873
♥JT54	♥A2
♦AQ4	♦J3
♣AJT2	♣986

West	North	East	South
1NT	Pass	4♥!	Pass
4♠	All Pass		

With a 6-card spade suit and game-going values, East bids 4♥ to transfer to spades.

West	East
♠AK5	♠QT7632
♥AQ3	♥K92
♦AQ4	♦T6
♣QT43	♣75

West	North	East	South
2NT	Pass	4♥!	Pass
4♠	All Pass		

Texas Transfers also work when you open 2NT. East has just enough values to warrant game.

In Competition

If the opponents compete over 1NT, Texas Transfers are only on if the interference is **lower than 3♦**. If the opponents compete over a 2NT opening bid, then Texas is off entirely.

West	East
♠AK84	♠52
♥J9	♥AKT8632
♦A752	♦43
♣KJT	♣Q2

West	North	East	South
1NT	Dbl	4♦!	Pass
4♥	All Pass		

4♦ is a Texas Transfer, requiring partner to rebid 4♥.

West	East
♠97	♠KJT86432
♥AQJ8	♥54
♦KT73	♦A
♣AQ2	♣65

West	North	East	South
1NT	3♣	4♥!	Pass
4♠	All Pass		

4♥ is a Texas Transfer asking partner to bid 4♠.

West	East
♠AK94	♠QJ2

	♥T82 ♦Q7 ♣AQJ2	
♥KQJ7654 ♦54 ♣8		

West	North	East	South
1NT	3♦	4♥	All Pass

4♥ is natural because North's overcall was higher than 3♣.

Other Considerations

- If you play Texas Transfers, then the following Jacoby Transfer auctions become superfluous:

West	East
1NT	2♦!
2♥	4♥

West	East
1NT	2♥!
2♠	4♠

  What do they mean now? These sequences show mild slam interest in hearts and spades respectively. Opener is allowed to make some exploratory noises with a good hand. In practice, I have never seen these auctions actually entice opener to push on toward slam. Especially if you play super-accepts in conjunction with Jacoby Transfers. In that case, opener's 2♥/♠ already denies a maximum since she failed to rebid 3♥/♠. But hey, some agreement is better than no agreement.

- It is easy to forget Texas Transfers, so make sure to remember them when they come up. There is nothing quite like going down 5 in a 6-card trump fit.
- Make sure you agree with your partner about when Texas is on and off after the opponents intervene, and be sure to remember that agreement as well.

Origins

Texas Transfers are attributed independently to American player David Carter of St. Louis, Missouri and Mr. Olle Willner of Sweden.

See also

- Four-Suit Transfers
  Artificial transfers into all four suits.
- Jacoby Transfers
  Major suit transfers at the 2-level.
- Minor Suit Transfers
  Transfers into clubs or diamonds, used after partner opens 1NT.
- South African Texas Transfers
  A variation of Texas using 4♣ and 4♦ bids.
- Yellow Rose of Texas
  An advanced extension of Texas transfers for slammish hands with 4-4-3-2 shape.